

Alina Pfrang

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Education and Experience

- Aug 2025–Present **Stanford University, Stanford, CA**
Postdoctoral Fellowship
Graduate School of Business & Stanford Tax Lab
- Feb–Jun 2025 **University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA**
Visiting Scholar
Tippie College of Business, Accounting Department
- 2020–2025 **University of Mannheim, Germany**
PhD in Accounting
Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences
Research Stays:
University of Texas at Austin, Jan–Mar 2024, Host: Prof. Lisa De Simone
University of Iowa, Apr–Jun 2024, Host: Prof. Jaron Wilde
- 2018–2020 **University of Mannheim, Germany**
MSc in Business Administration
- 2015–2018 **University of Passau, Germany**
BSc in Economics

Research

Interests: Real effects of business taxation, Environmental tax policy, Tax reporting, Anti-tax avoidance

Publication

“How to Improve Small Firms’ Payroll Tax Compliance? Evidence from a Randomized Field Experiment” with Philipp Doerrenberg and Jan Schmitz. *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*, 2026, 4(3).

Job Market Paper

“Firm Responses to Clean Energy Tax Credit Transfers: Investment, Tax Planning, and Disclosures” *Working Paper*.

Clean energy tax credits are a primary way for governments to encourage firms to invest in renewable energy. However, they only help firms that owe taxes, and many clean energy firms do not, making the credits unusable in the short run. The U.S. Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) of 2022 addressed this by making the credits transferable, allowing clean energy firms to sell them to other firms for cash. This created a new multi-billion dollar market, dramatically increasing access to clean energy tax credits. Using a novel hand-collected dataset of disclosed tax credit transfers, I examine how buying and selling firms respond. On the seller side, I use stacked cohort difference-in-differences designs to examine whether improved credit monetization affects clean energy investment and investment quality. I find that selling firms increase capital expenditures, productive assets, and generators after their first transfer,

with the increase concentrated in clean technologies. I find no change in investment quality. On the buyer side, participation expands sharply and diversifies relative to pre-IRA clean energy financing. Buying firms are more profitable, have higher ESG scores, and are more likely to have emissions targets than other potential buyers. I find no significant decline in buyers' effective tax rates following a purchase, but firms incorporate tax credit purchases into the environmental narratives of their sustainability reports. Overall, transferability shifts both real investment in clean energy and the set of firms financing it.

Working Papers

"Do Substance Rules Have Substance? Firm Responses to Anti-Tax Avoidance Rules" with Emilia Gschossmann. *Working Paper*.

"Tax Reporting Simplification and Firm Behavior" with Philipp Doerrenberg and Christin Schmidt. *Working Paper*.

"The Impact of Environmental Taxes on Commercial Traffic and Its Environmental Consequences" *Working Paper*.

Work in Progress

"Stacking Taxes: Local Business Taxes and Political Feedback" with Rebecca Lester. *Work in Progress*.

Policy Work

"Rethinking Anti-Tax Avoidance Measures in the European Union" with Johannes Gaul, Alexander Goebel, Emilia Gschossmann, Hannah Gundert, Felix Jungmann, Daniel Kaeshammer, Cornelia Kindler, Thu Thao Porebski, Christin Schmidt, Katharina Schmidt, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Julia Spix, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *ZEW Discussion Paper, 2026*.

"Comments on the Call for an Evaluation of the Anti-Tax Avoidance Directive" with Johannes Gaul, Alexander Goebel, Hannah Gundert, Emilia Gschossmann, Felix Jungmann, Christin Schmidt, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Julia Spix, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *EU Consultation Anti-Tax Avoidance Directive, 2024*.

"The Global Minimum Tax – Costs and Benefits from a German Perspective" with Johannes Gaul, Jessica Mueller, Daniel Klein, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *Der Betrieb 76 (1), 2023*.

"Significant Costs, Limited Benefits: A Global Minimum Tax in Germany" with Johannes Gaul, Jessica Mueller, Daniel Klein, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *ZEW Policy Brief No. 07, 2022*.

Refereeing Activities

Management Science, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Accounting and Public Policy, Junior Management Science

Conferences and Seminars

** indicates presenter; otherwise attendee.*

- 2026 American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting*, *Nashville, TN*
Economic Growth and Public Policy Conference*, *Chicago, IL*
Texas Tax Theory Seminar, University of Texas at Austin, *Austin, TX*
Norwegian Tax Accounting Symposium, *Bergen, Norway*
SITE Conference Public Economics, *Stanford, CA*
Stanford Accounting Summer Camp, *Stanford, CA*
Texas-Waterloo Taxation Research Symposium, *Waterloo, Canada*
- 2025 American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting & Doctoral Consortium*, *Dallas, TX*
University of Iowa, Accounting Seminar*, *Iowa City, IA*
Stanford Accounting Summer Camp, *Stanford, CA*
University of Illinois Symposium on Tax Research, *Chicago, IL*
National Tax Association Meetings*, *Boston, MA*
Environmental and Energy Economics Fest*, *Stanford University, CA*
- 2024 University of Texas at Austin, Accounting Seminar*, *Austin, TX*
American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting & Doctoral Consortium, *Long Beach, CA*
University of Iowa, Accounting Seminar*, *Iowa City, IO*
EIASM Conference on Current Research in Taxation*, *Porto, Portugal*
International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress*, *Prague, Czechia*
MannheimTaxation Conference*, *Mannheim, Germany*
- 2023 CESifo Delphi Conference*, *Hydra, Greece*
MannheimTaxation Conference*, *Mannheim, Germany*
Vienna Doctoral Consortium in Taxation*, *Vienna, Austria*
Doctoral Seminar by the German Ministry of Finance, *Berlin, Germany*
MannheimTaxation Campus Meeting*, *Mannheim, Germany*
German Ministry of Finance International Tax Policy Symposium, *Berlin, Germany*
- 2022 Vienna Doctoral Consortium in Taxation*, *Vienna, Austria*
Berlin-Vallendar Conference on Tax Research*, *WHU Vallendar, Germany*
TUM Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business*, *Heilbronn, Germany*
MannheimTaxation Conference*, *Mannheim, Germany*
- 2021 MannheimTaxation Campus Meeting*, *Mannheim, Germany*
International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress*, *online*

Invited Discussions

- 2026 Norwegian Tax Accounting Symposium, *Bergen, Norway*
- 2025 National Tax Association Meeting, *Boston, MA*
- 2024 EIASM Conference on Current Research in Taxation, *Porto, Portugal*
International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress, *Prague, Czechia*
MannheimTaxation Conference, *Mannheim, Germany*
Doctoral Tax Seminar, ZEW, *Mannheim, Germany*
- 2023 MannheimTaxation Conference, *Mannheim, Germany*
Vienna Doctoral Consortium in Taxation, *Vienna, Austria*
Doctoral Tax Seminar, ZEW, *Mannheim, Germany*

Teaching and Supervision

- 2026 The Real and Reporting Effects of Business Taxation, PhD Course, *Norwegian School of Economics & ENGAGE.EU*
Teaching Assistant
- 2025 Taxes and Business Strategy, Master's, *University of Iowa*
Instructor
- 2023–25 Introduction to Scientific Writing, Bachelor's, *University of Mannheim*
Instructor, 3 terms
- 2021–25 Introduction to Financial Accounting, Bachelor's, *University of Mannheim*
Teaching Assistant, Taught Exercise Classes, 4 terms
- 2020–25 The Role of Taxes for Business Decisions, Master's, *University of Mannheim*
Teaching Assistant, Taught Exercise Classes, 5 terms
- 2023 Corporate Socially Responsible Taxation, Master's, *Mannheim Business School*
Guest Lecture
- 2021–25 Master's Thesis Supervision, *University of Mannheim* (6×)
Bachelor's Thesis Supervision, *University of Mannheim* (9×)
Seminar Thesis Supervision, *University of Mannheim* (4×)

Fellowships and Grants

- 2025 Lazear Liang Postdoctoral Fellowship, Stanford University, Graduate School of Business
- 2024 Women Go Abroad DAAD Travel Grant
MannheimTaxation Travel Grant
American Taxation Association-KPMG Doctoral Consortium Fellow
- 2023 Gamified Financial Accounting Learning and Accounting Video Library, Foundation for Innovation in University Teaching (Stiftung Innovation in der Hochschullehre), with Philipp Doerrenberg and Johannes Gaul

References

Rebecca Lester

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